

KYB Company Registry API Guide

Nigerian CAC Registry Lookup API — REST Reference v1.0

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Overview

The Cellion One KYB (Know Your Business) API provides programmatic access to the Nigerian Corporate Affairs Commission (CAC) registry via Smile ID. Use it to verify a company's registration number, retrieve its official name, registration date, company type, and directors list — all in a single API call.

Common use cases: bank onboarding, supplier due diligence, trade credit decisions, and automated KYB pipelines.

Base URL

```
https://cellionone.com/api/v1/kyb
```

Authentication

All KYB endpoints require an API key with the `verify:business` scope. Include the key in every request using the `X-API-Key` header.

```
curl -X POST https://cellionone.com/api/v1/kyb/lookup \  
-H "X-API-Key: co_live_a1b2c3d4e5f6g7h8i9j0k1l2m3n4o5p6" \  
-H "Content-Type: application/json" \  
-d '{"rcNumber": "9228748"}'
```

Credit Pricing

KYB lookups consume credits from your organisation's KYB credit balance.

- 5,000 per lookup (1 credit)
- Credits are pre-purchased via Paystack (minimum 10 credits)
- 1 credit is deducted per successful lookup (found or not_found)
- Errors due to service unavailability do not deduct credits

businessType Codes

co	Private limited company (Ltd) — default
bn	Business Name (sole proprietorship)
it	Incorporated Trustee (NGO / association)

Endpoints

POST /api/v1/kyb/lookup Perform a CAC registry lookup by RC number

Checks your KYB credit balance, calls the CAC registry via Smile ID, stores the result, and deducts one credit. Returns the full company record immediately (synchronous).

Request Parameters:

rcNumber	string	Required	RC number. Digits only or with RC prefix (e.g. '9228748' or 'RC9228748'). Max 20 chars.
businessType	string	Optional	Company category: co (default), bn, or it.

Example Request Body:

```
{
  "rcNumber": "9228748",
  "businessType": "co"
}
```

Success Response (200 — found):

```
{
  "reference": "kyb_1_1744000000_a1b2c3d4",
  "status": "found",
  "rcNumber": "9228748",
  "businessType": "co",
  "companyName": "CELLION PLATFORMS NIGERIA LIMITED",
  "registrationDate": "2022-08-15",
  "companyStatus": "ACTIVE",
  "companyType": "LTD",
  "address": "51 Raymond Njoku Street, Lagos, Nigeria",
  "shareCapital": "1000000",
  "tinNumber": "12345678-0001",
  "directors": [
    { "name": "EMEKA OKORO", "role": "DIRECTOR" },
    { "name": "NGOZI ADEYEMI", "role": "DIRECTOR" }
  ],
  "creditDeducted": true,
}
```

Not Found Response (404):

```
{
  "reference": "kyb_1_1744000001_b2c3d4e5",
  "status": "not_found",
  "rcNumber": "0000001",
  "businessType": "co",
  "companyName": null,
  "directors": null,
  "creditDeducted": true,
  "createdAt": "2026-04-12T10:31:00.000Z"
}
```

GET

/api/v1/kyb/lookups

List all KYB lookups for your organisation

Returns lookups sorted by createdAt descending. Supports pagination via limit (default 50, max 200) and offset query parameters.

Example Request:

```
GET /api/v1/kyb/lookups?limit=20&offset=0
```

Response:

```
{
  "data": [ /* array of lookup records */ ],
  "limit": 20,
  "offset": 0,
  "returnedCount": 20
}
```

GET

/api/v1/kyb/lookups/:reference

Retrieve a single lookup by reference

Fetch a previously performed lookup by its reference string. Only lookups belonging to your organisation are accessible.

Example:

```
GET /api/v1/kyb/lookups/kyb_1_1744000000_a1b2c3d4
```

companyStatus Values

ACTIVE	Company is in good standing with CAC
INACTIVE	Company is registered but not actively trading
DISSOLVED	Company has been formally wound up
STRUCK_OFF	Company struck off the register by CAC
CONVERTED	Company type has changed via conversion filing
SUSPENDED	CAC has suspended the company's registration

KYB-Specific Error Codes

INSUFFICIENT_CREDITS	402	No KYB credits remaining — purchase more to continue
INVALID_API_KEY	401	API key missing, invalid, or lacks verify:business scope
RC_NOT_FOUND	404	RC number not found in the CAC registry
INVALID_RC_FORMAT	400	rcNumber must be numeric digits or RC-prefixed digits
LOOKUP_NOT_FOUND	404	GET /:reference — reference does not exist for your org
REGISTRY_SERVICE_ERROR	502	Upstream CAC registry is temporarily unavailable
RATE_LIMIT_EXCEEDED	429	60 req/min per API key — retry with backoff

Integration Notes

1. Store the reference field returned by POST /lookup — use it to retrieve the record later via GET /lookups/:reference.
2. The API is synchronous — no webhook is fired for KYB lookups. The full result is in the POST response body.
3. Rate limit: 60 requests per minute per API key. For bulk lookups, implement exponential back-off on 429 responses.
4. The rawResult field is omitted from API responses to keep payloads clean. Contact support if you need access to raw Smile ID data.

5. KYB credits and KYC credits are tracked separately in your billing account. Purchase KYB credits from the KYC organisation settings page.

Support

For API support and integration guidance, contact:

service@cellionone.com

<https://cellionone.com/api-docs>